



Issued Regardless

Phone-Pouch Distribution Held Flat Across Nine Terms of Rising Online Invigilation

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Background

Every exam sitting still issues one sealed phone pouch per candidate. A rising share of sittings now run entirely online, where no candidate sits in a room to seal one. Has the pouch protocol been asked to justify itself since?

Aims

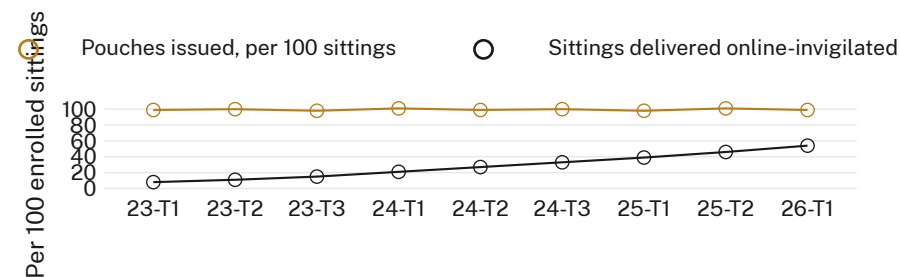
- Track pouches issued per exam sitting across nine teaching periods
- Compare issuance against each period's online-invigilated share
- Establish whether the protocol has ever been reviewed against delivery mode

Methods

- 9 teaching periods (2023-T1 to 2026-T1) · Office of Research Outputs procurement and distribution logs · pouch counts reconciled against enrolled-sitting totals
- Linear trend fit of pouches issued per sitting against each period's online-invigilated share
- Distribution protocol held constant throughout; no override on record for any sitting type

Results

Pouches issued per enrolled sitting held between 98 and 101 per hundred across all nine periods, regardless of delivery mode. The trend shows no association with the rising online-invigilated share.



Phone-pouch issuance held at 98–101 units per 100 enrolled sittings across nine teaching periods (T1 2023 – T1 2026), even as the online-invigilated share of sittings rose from 8% to 54%.

Discussion & conclusions

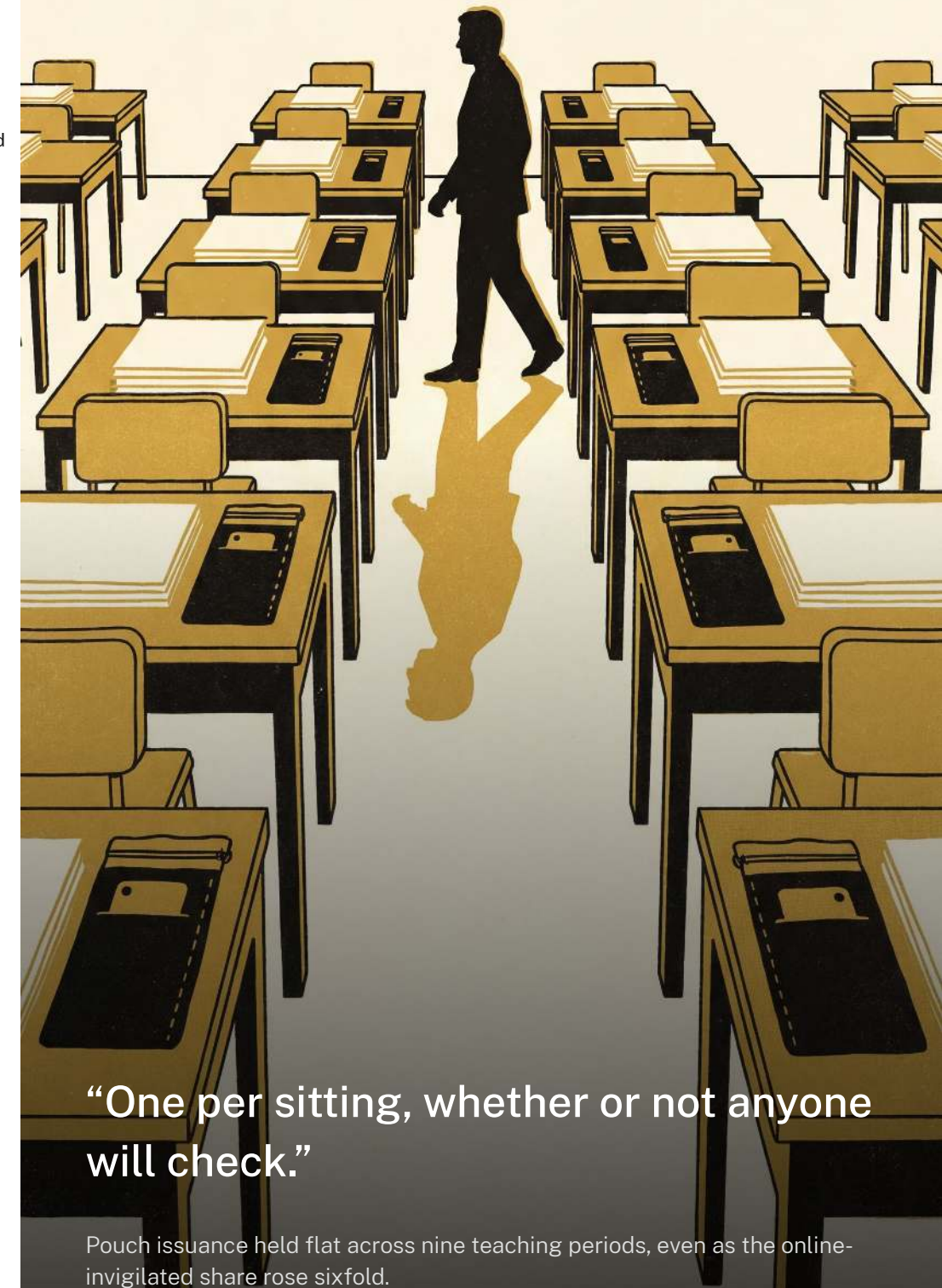
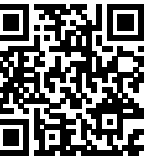
The pouch travels with the sitting record, not the sitting itself. No period shows a reduced allocation for online-invigilated cohorts. Next: audit whether an online-invigilated sitting's pouch is collected unopened, stored, or simply written off the tally.

References

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Distribution records only; no pouch openings observed directly.

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“One per sitting, whether or not anyone will check.”

Pouch issuance held flat across nine teaching periods, even as the online-invigilated share rose sixfold.